How-To Library

Informatica

Importing Metadata From an XML Source in Test Data Management

© Copyright Informatica LLC 2017, 2021. Informatica, the Informatica logo, and PowerCenter are trademarks or registered trademarks of Informatica LLC in the United States and many jurisdictions throughout the world. A current list of Informatica trademarks is available on the web at https://www.informatica.com/trademarks.html

Abstract

You can use XML sources to perform tasks in Test Data Management (TDM). This article describes the steps to import metadata from an XSD file in Test Data Manager. This article assumes that you have knowledge of TDM and are familiar with TDM operations.

Supported Versions

- Test Data Management 10.2.0
- Test Data Management 10.1.0
- Test Data Management 9.7.1 HotFix 1
- Test Data Management 9.7.1

Table of Contents

Overview. 2
Rules and Guidelines. 2
Example Scenario. 3
Import the XSD Metadata into PowerCenter 3
Create a Project and Import the Source Metadata into Test Data Manager. 6
Copy the Source File to the Informatica Server. 7

Overview

You can perform data subset, data masking, and data generation operations on XML sources.

To perform a TDM operation on an XML file, import the source metadata into Test Data Manager. You can then assign subset criteria, data masking rules, or data generation rules to the elements and attributes to perform data subset, data masking or data generation. You cannot import metadata from an XML source directly into Test Data Manager. Import the metadata into the PowerCenter repository. You can import XML source metadata from the PowerCenter repository into Test Data Manager.

You can view the list of XSD files in a project from the Files tab in the **Discover** view in Test Data Manager. You can open and view the properties of each file in a separate page.

Rules and Guidelines

When you use an XML source in a TDM operation, consider the following rules and guidelines:

- You cannot import metadata from an XML source directly into Test Data Manager. You must first import the XSD metadata into PowerCenter from PowerCenter Designer and then import the XSD from the PowerCenter repository into Test Data Manager.
- To perform a data subset or data masking operation, the XML source file must be present in the Informatica server source file location.
- If the XML file contains the name of the XSD file, the XSD file must also be present in the Informatica server source file location.

Example Scenario

You work for a product test team that creates test data from master data that customers provide.

A customer provides an XML representation of its golden record data. To create test data, you run a TDM operation to create a data subset and apply data masking rules to elements and attributes in the data. Before you run the TDM operation to create test data, you must import the source metadata into Test Data Manager. You can then run a plan to create the test data.

To import the XSD data into Test Data Manager, perform the following steps:

1. Import the source metadata into PowerCenter.
2. Create a project and import the XSD into Test Data Manager.

Before you perform a data subset or data masking operation on an XML source, the source file must be present in the Informatica server.

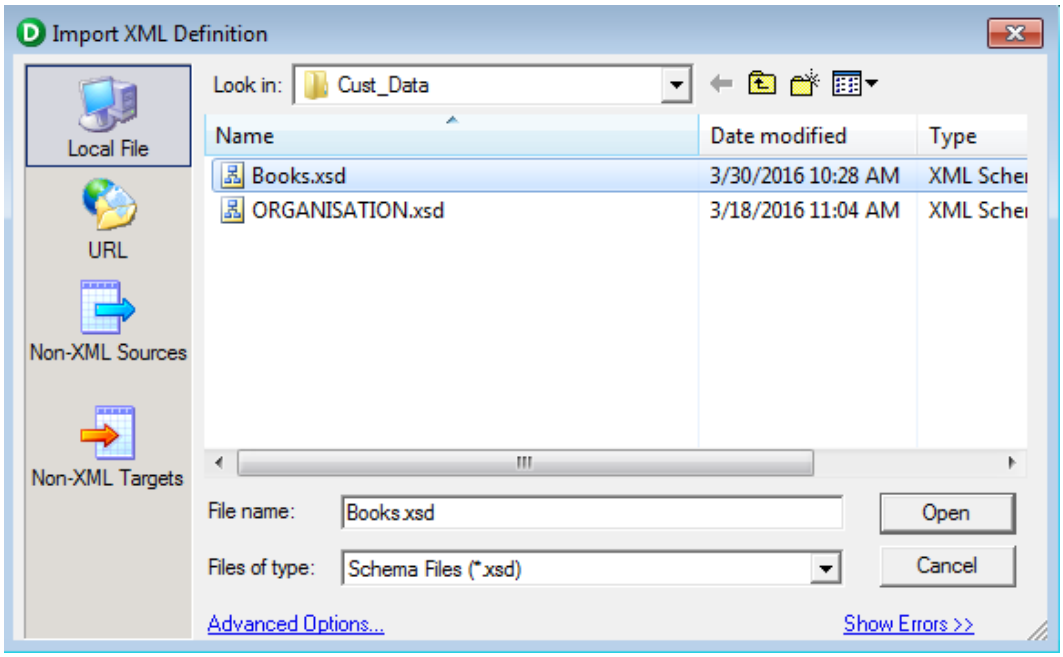
Import the XSD Metadata into PowerCenter

Import the XSD metadata into the PowerCenter repository before you import the metadata into Test Data Manager.

1. Open the Repository Manager and connect to the required PowerCenter repository.
2. Click **Folder** > **Create**.
3. Enter a name and click **OK** to create the folder.
4. Refresh the repository connection to update the changes.
5. Open the Designer and connect to the required PowerCenter repository.

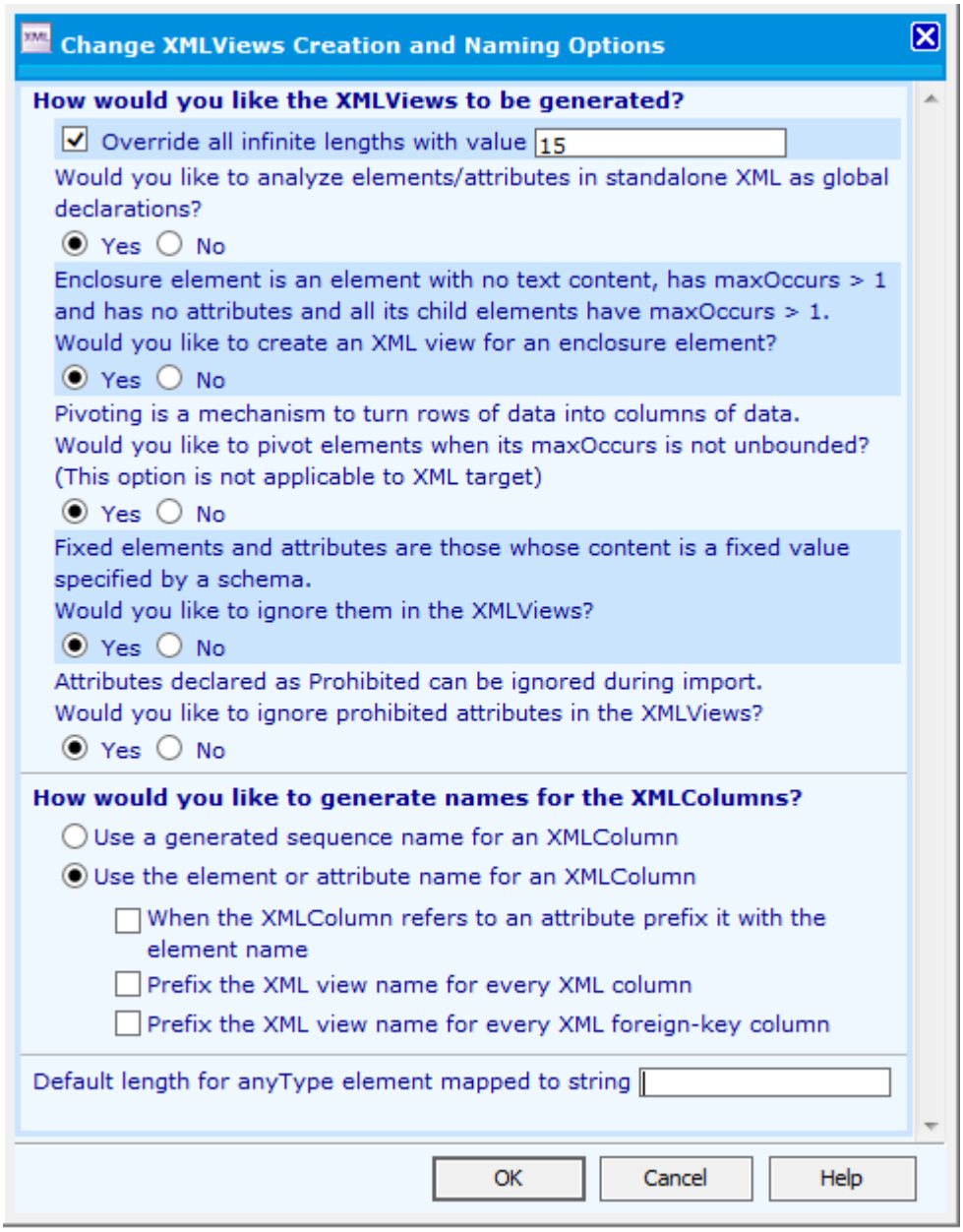
   The folder that you created in Repository Manager is visible in the navigation panel.
6. Select the folder that you created.
7. Click **Tools** > **Source Analyzer** to open the Source Analyzer.
8. Click **Sources** > **Import XML Definition**.
9. Browse to select the XSD file that you want to import.

The following image shows step 2 of the XML import wizard:



10. Click **Advanced Options** to open the **Change XML Views Creation and Naming Options** window.

The following image shows the **Change XML Views Creation and Naming Options** window:



11. Configure the following settings:

- Choose to override all infinite lengths with a low value. The value is the default length if the XSD file does not specify a length. You do not require a high value if the elements are of a small length. A high length value requires more memory and affects the performance. Select the option and enter an override value.

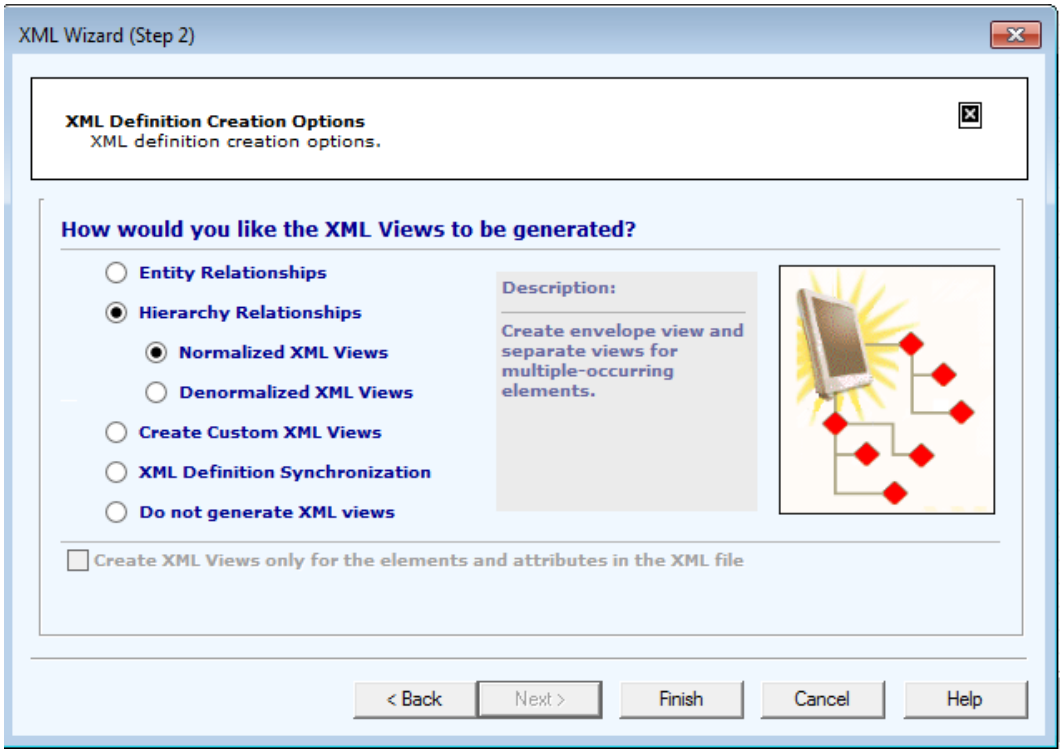
  Note: If the data contains elements that require a higher precision, manually set the precision of the element to the required value after you import the file. Open the file in Designer and select the element in the **Schema Components** panel. Edit the length on the **Actions** tab.

- Choose to analyze elements and attributes in standalone XML as global declarations. Test Data Manager analyzes elements and attributes as global declarations to ensure correct mapping of the namespaces of the different elements and attributes. Import of the XSD in TDM fails if the namespaces of elements and attributes are not mapped correctly.

- Use the default settings for the other options.
- Enter a value in the **Default length for anyType element mapped to string** field.

12. Click **OK** and then click **Open**.
13. Edit the name if required and click **Next**.
14. In the **XML Definition Creation Options** page, select **Hierarchy Relationships and the Normalized XML Views** option.

    The following image shows the **XML Definition Creation Options** page of the XML import wizard:



    Use this option to create a root and expand the XML components under the root. When you choose normalized XML views, every element or attribute appears once. One-to-many relationships become separate XML views with keys to relate the views. If you create denormalized XML views, all elements and attributes display in one hierarchical group.

15. Click **Finish**.

    The data appears in the Source Analyzer.

16. Click **Repository** > **Save**.

You can import the source metadata from the PowerCenter repository into Test Data Manager.

Create a Project and Import the Source Metadata into Test Data Manager

Create a project and import the metadata into the project to perform TDM operations on source data.

1. Log in to Test Data Manager.
2. Click **Projects** to access the projects.
3. Click **Actions** > **New**.

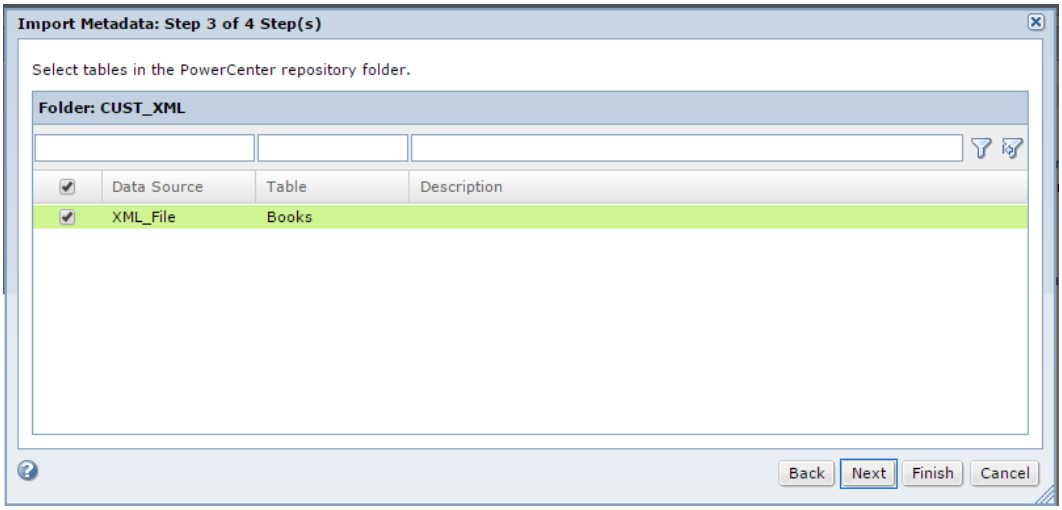
The **Create Project** dialog box opens.

4. Enter a name and optional description and click **OK** to create the project.
5. Click **Actions** > **Import Metadata**.

   The **Import Metadata** window appears.
6. Choose to import metadata from the PowerCenter repository and click **Next**.

   You cannot directly import metadata from an XML source in Test Data Manager.
7. Select the folder into which you imported the source metadata in Designer and click **Next**.
8. Filter and select the required tables and click **Next**.

   The following image shows the third step in the **Import Metadata** wizard:



9. Choose to import the metadata now and click **Finish**.

You can use the metadata from the XSD file to perform data subset, data masking, or data generation operations in TDM.

Copy the Source File to the Informatica Server

To perform a data subset or data masking operation on an XML source, the source file must be present in the machine that hosts the Informatica server. If the XML file refers the XSD, you must copy the XSD file to the Informatica server.

1. Log in to the Informatica Server machine.
2. Browse to the source file location. The default location is `<Informatica install directory>\server\infa_shared\SrcFiles`.
3. Copy the XML file that you want to use in a TDM operation to the source files location.
4. Optional. Copy the XSD file to the source files location.

   You must copy the XSD file if the XML file contains the name of the XSD file.

You can run a plan to perform data subset or data masking on the XML source.

Author

Sadhana Kamath

Acknowledgements

The author would like to acknowledge Ramachandra Madaka and Hanumanthareddy Syamala for their technical assistance.